I loved every minute of the build-up: tasting the food, trying the wines and choosing the music. Everything went really smoothly—amazing, really, considering how complicated the arrangements were—until it came to getting the bride's frock across the Irish Sea. Now, bear in mind I wasn't supposed to see Victoria's wedding dress until the day. The people at *OK!* were so nervous about things that they chartered a small private plane to take us to Ireland. Brooklyn, me, Victoria, her mum and dad, sister Louise—with her baby, Liberty—and brother Christian had all squeezed in before the crew told us that the big box with the Big Secret wouldn't fit in the hold. Which meant the dress had to come out of the box to get it in through the passenger door. So I was sent off to stand on the runway with my eyes shut for twenty minutes. I had to sit with my back to the thing all the way to Dublin and, of course, once we touched down, we had to go through the entire routine all over again. I wasn't supposed to see it and, of course, we had to make sure that any cameras couldn't either. Pity: the afternoon would have made quite a good silent movie.

We got to the castle two days before our wedding day. Mum and Dad flew out and other guests started arriving the following evening. We had a big dinner for everyone the night before. After the meal, Victoria and I went out in the castle grounds for a walk together. We headed down to the marquee where the reception was going to take place. There was a little grove that had been made out of branches, and holly and flowers, which people would have to walk underneath to get inside. I'd brought along a couple of glasses and a bottle of champagne. I was telling Victoria, again, how much I loved her and, all of a sudden, this soft rain started falling. On a warm summer's evening, it felt perfect. I couldn't have imagined anything more romantic.

Eventually, bride and groom had to go their separate ways for the night. Back at the castle, Victoria, of course, had the best room in the place: our wedding suite. I had to make do with another guest room downstairs. Before I went to bed, the United players and some of my mates got together: it wasn't very wild as stag evenings go. Everyone was pretty tired and we just went through and had a couple of drinks and a game or two on the snooker table. Two o'clock and sober, that was me. I wanted to look half-decent the following morning and I wanted to be sure I'd remember every second of it.

I got back to my room and started fretting about my speech. I knew I wanted to thank mum and Dad for everything, Lynne and Joanne too, to thank Jackie and Tony and Victoria's brother and sister for making me so welcome into their family: Christian had turned into something like the brother I'd always wanted to have. And then to talk about Victoria who, by this stage in